

THE CLAUDE BEAST

SuperPowers / GSD / OpenSpec / Speckit

Structured Development Workflows for AI Coding Agents

Episode 07 | The Claude Beast Series | February 2026

The End of "Vibe Coding"

Why unstructured AI coding fails at scale

- **Context Rot** — Quality degrades as the AI fills its context window with noise
- **Intent Drift** — The AI gradually loses sight of what you actually wanted to build
- **Inconsistent Output** — Same prompt, different results -- no reproducibility
- **Poor Test Coverage** — Without enforced testing, regressions pile up silently
- **No Source of Truth** — Prompting iteratively without shared specs leads to chaos

Superpowers

59.8K stars | By Jesse Vincent (obra) | MIT License | Oct 2025

- **Philosophy** — An enforced development methodology -- the agent cannot skip steps
- **Mandatory TDD** — Write tests first, always. If code is written before tests, it gets deleted
- **7-Phase Workflow** — Brainstorm > Git Worktree > Plan > Subagent Execution > TDD > Code Review > Finish
- **Subagent Architecture** — Each task gets a fresh 200K-token context window -- no context rot
- **Plans as Specs** — Tasks broken into 2-5 min chunks, unambiguous enough for a junior engineer
- **20+ Composable Skills** — Auto-trigger based on context (debugging, collaboration, testing)

GSD — Get Shit Done

19.7K stars | By TACHES | MIT License | Dec 2025

- **Tagline** — Meta-prompting, context engineering, and spec-driven development
- **Wave Execution** — Independent plans run in parallel; dependent plans run sequentially
- **Context Engineering Files** — PROJECT.md, REQUIREMENTS.md, ROADMAP.md, STATE.md, PLAN.md
- **Model Profiles** — Quality (Opus/Opus), Balanced (Opus/Sonnet), Budget (Sonnet/Haiku)
- **24 Commands** — From /gsd:new-project to /gsd:quick for ad-hoc tasks without ceremony
- **Atomic Commits** — Every task gets its own git commit -- enables precise git bisect

OpenSpec

25.4K stars | By Fission AI | MIT License | Aug 2025

- **Only 3 Core Commands** — /opsx:propose, /opsx:apply, /opsx:archive -- minimal ceremony
- **Change Isolation** — Each change lives in its own folder, like git branches for specs
- **GIVEN/WHEN/THEN Specs** — Behavioral spec format with types: ADDED, MODIFIED, REMOVED
- **Token Efficient** — Specs typically under 2,000 tokens -- maximum context for implementation
- **20+ Tool Support** — Works with Claude Code, Cursor, Copilot, Gemini CLI, and many more

Spec Kit

71.4K stars | By GitHub (official) | MIT License | Aug 2025

- **GitHub's Official SDD Toolkit** — Specs become executable -- directly generating implementations
- **6-Phase Workflow** — Constitution > Specify > Clarify > Plan > Tasks > Implement
- **The Constitution** — 9 immutable principles (Library-First, Test-First, Anti-Abstraction, etc.)
- **Traceability** — @spec, @task, @acceptance comments link every line of code back to specs
- **Auto-Branching** — Creates git branches per feature (e.g., 001-create-taskify)
- **Validation Reports** — Spec coverage, test coverage, constitution compliance, doc status

Head-to-Head Comparison

	Superpowers	GSD	OpenSpec	Spec Kit
Stars	59,800+	19,700+	25,400+	71,400+
Created	Oct 2025	Dec 2025	Aug 2025	Aug 2025
Author	Jesse Vincent	TACHES	Fission AI	GitHub
Core Strength	Mandatory TDD + Subagents	Meta-prompting + Waves	Lightweight Brownfield Specs	Comprehensive Governance
Ceremony	Medium	Medium-Low	Low	High
Best For	Large multi-file features	Solo/small team builders	Existing codebase evolution	Enterprise/team projects
TDD	Enforced	Not enforced	Not enforced	Principle-based
Multi-Runtime	4 tools	4 tools	20+ tools	20+ tools

Choosing the Right Tool

Different workflows for different needs

- **Solo developer building fast** — GSD or OpenSpec -- minimal ceremony, maximum velocity
- **Large feature with strict quality** — Superpowers -- enforced TDD and subagent isolation
- **Enterprise team with governance** — Spec Kit -- constitution, traceability, validation reports
- **Brownfield / legacy codebase** — OpenSpec -- designed specifically for evolving existing code
- **Enforced TDD culture** — Superpowers -- the only tool that mechanically prevents skipping tests

The New Paradigm: Spec-Driven Development

Key themes emerging across the ecosystem

- **Intent > Code** — The source of truth shifts from code to specifications and intent
- **Context is King** — Subagent architectures and lean specs keep AI context windows clean
- **Specs as Living Docs** — Specifications are executable artifacts, not dusty documents
- **175K+ Stars Combined** — All four projects created between Aug-Dec 2025 -- explosive growth
- **Convergent Evolution** — Independent teams arriving at the same conclusion -- structure wins

Key Takeaways & Next Steps

TAKEAWAYS

- **Vibe coding is over** — structured workflows are the new standard
- Spec-driven development makes AI output reliable and reproducible
- Context engineering prevents the #1 failure mode of AI coding
- **The ecosystem is young and fast-moving** — adopt early, iterate often

TRY IT TODAY

- **Start small** — Pick one tool and try it on your next feature
- **Install** — `/plugin install superpowers@superpowers-marketplace`
- **Install** — `npx get-shit-done-cc@latest`
- **Install** — `npm install -g @fission-ai/openspec@latest`
- **Install** — `uv tool install specify-cli`